

JUSTICEFLOW

LEGAL PRACTICE MANAGEMENT

SYSTEM

Complete User Manual, Operational Workflow & Technical Guide for Clients & Law

Firms

Application Version: 1.0 Enterprise Edition

Platform Architecture: Decoupled Node.js Microservices + Angular 17 / Ionic

Author: JusticeFlow Engineering Team

Target Audience: Managing Partners, Senior Counsel, Associates, Paralegals & Law Firm Clients

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1. Executive Overview

JusticeFlow is a modern case management software designed specifically for law firms, legal clinics, and corporate legal departments. In standard practice, law firms suffer from disconnected tools: emails scattered across inboxes, court pleadings lost in desktop folders, missed filing deadlines, and untracked billable hours that lead to revenue leakage.

JusticeFlow integrates the entire lifecycle of legal practice into a unified, secure operating system:

- **Retainer Management:** Maintain verified contact profiles for both corporations and individuals.

- **Matter & Docket Tracking:** Track every lawsuit, arbitration, patent defense, and corporate filing through dedicated stages.
- **Budget Guardrails:** Proactively monitor legal expenses against client-approved budget caps to prevent billing disputes.
- **Privileged Document Repository:** Centralized digital filing cabinet for pleadings, motions, and evidence exhibits.
- **Contemporary Time Capture:** Log billable hours in real-time with automated rate calculations and realization reporting.

2. System Architecture in Simple Terms

JusticeFlow is built using an **independent microservice architecture**. Instead of one large monolithic software where a single failure halts the entire firm, JusticeFlow separates duties into 6 dedicated services coordinated through an **API Gateway**:

Service Component	Port	Primary Responsibility	Why This Matters to the Firm
API Gateway	5000	Traffic director & security checkpoint	Single point of entry that routes all client and lawyer requests securely.
Auth Service	3001	Staff identities & passwords	Guarantees that only authorized personnel can see confidential case records.
Client Service	3002	Client CRM & retainers	Organizes corporate clients, billing addresses, and assigned partner lawyers.
Case Service	3003	Legal matters & court dockets	Maintains case numbers, court branches, assigned judges, and approved budgets.
Documents Service	3004	File storage & downloads	Stores legal pleadings, briefs, exhibits, and contracts with download links.

Service Component	Port	Primary Responsibility	Why This Matters to the Firm
Time Tracking Service	3005	Billable hours & fee realization	Captures attorney work slips and automatically updates case budget utilization.

3. End-to-End Legal Practice Workflow

The system mirrors the actual day-to-day legal workflow in five seamless stages:

1. **Client Retainer:** A new corporate entity or individual retains the firm. Their profile, jurisdiction, and lead counsel are saved in the *Client Directory*.
2. **Matter Inception:** A specific matter is opened (e.g. *Commercial Breach of Contract*) with an assigned docket number, court, judge, and client budget.
3. **Evidence & Pleadings:** Complaint files, contracts, and filings are uploaded to the matter file in the *Documents Repository*.
4. **Legal Service & Time Slips:** Attorneys and paralegals record work performed (e.g., 3.5 hours drafting deposition questions at \$450/hour).
5. **Financial Burn-Down:** The matter's budget is automatically recalculated and visually tracked on the *Executive Dashboard*.

4. Detailed Page-by-Page User Guide

Screen 1: Secure Portal Authentication (`/login`)

URL: `http://localhost:4200/login`

Purpose: The front door of the firm. Protects all privileged legal information.

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- **Sign-In & Register:** Toggle between logging into an existing account or registering
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new staff.

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- **Password Encryption:** Passwords are cryptographically salted and hashed before
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storing in the database.

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- **One-Click Demo Buttons:** Instant credentials autofill for quick login during
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evaluations.

Screen 2: Executive Practice Dashboard (`/dashboard`)

URL: `http://localhost:4200/dashboard`

Purpose: The cockpit for managing partners and legal teams to inspect business health

in seconds.

- **Active Matters Card:** Shows how many cases are currently in discovery or trial.

- **Retained Clients Card:** Shows the active retained client base.

- **Billable Hours Card:** Real-time count of all hours worked across the firm.

- **Billed Realization Card:** Total fee revenue earned from client work slips.

- **Active Matters Table:** Features color-coded progress bars showing how much of

each case's budget has been consumed.

- **Court Deadlines Calendar:** Displays upcoming court appearances, motions, and

trial dates.

Screen 3: Client Master Directory (`/clients`)

URL: `http://localhost:4200/clients`

Purpose: Complete CRM for managing client retainers, corporate representatives, and

conflict checks.

- **Client Records:** Shows corporate name, contact email, phone, location, and

assigned lead attorney.

- **Matters Counter:** Shows the number of active lawsuits linked to each client.

- **Add/Edit Modal:** Retain a new client or update existing contact details.

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- **Quick Search & Status Filter:** Instant search by name, city, or phone number.
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Screen 4: Legal Matters & Cases (`/cases`)

URL: `http://localhost:4200/cases`

Purpose: The core docket manager tracking all lawsuits, arbitrations, and transactions.

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- **Practice Area Filters:** Filter by Commercial Litigation, Corporate Securities,
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Intellectual Property, Probate, or Real Estate.

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- **Status Badges:** Open (in discovery), Pending (in trial), On Hold (settlement stay),
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Closed (resolved).

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- **Budget Meter:** Visual green/yellow/red bar indicating financial burn.
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- **New Matter Modal:** Allows entry of court jurisdiction, judge, docket number, and
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approved budget.

Screen 5: 360° Case Detail & File Dossier (`/cases/:id`)

URL: `http://localhost:4200/cases/1`

Purpose: The complete virtual trial binder for a specific lawsuit.

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- **Financial Health Box:** Shows exact budget spent versus approved cap with
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percentage.

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- **Court & Client Cards:** Instant access to presiding judge, court branch, and client
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contact info.

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- **Tab 1 — Legal Documents:** Lists all complaints, motions, and contracts attached
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to this case with direct download links.

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- **Tab 2 — Logged Hours:** Complete itemized ledger of every attorney time slip
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recorded for this matter.

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- **Tab 3 — Factual Synopsis:** Strategic notes and factual background of the case.
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Screen 6: Legal Documents & Evidence Repository (`/documents`)

URL: `http://localhost:4200/documents`

Purpose: Centralized law firm filing cabinet preventing misplaced files.

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- **Classification Filter:** Pleadings, Contracts, Exhibits, Orders, Term Sheets, and
-

Settlement Agreements.

- **Document Upload Modal:** Upload real PDF and DOCX attachments linked to any

legal matter.

- **Download Stream:** Securely stream documents to your computer.

Screen 7: Attorney Time Tracking & Billing (`/time-tracking`)

URL: `http://localhost:4200/time-tracking`

Purpose: The revenue engine of the law firm.

- **Revenue Metrics:** Total billable hours and billed realization across all matters.

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- **Log Time Slip Modal:** Input matter, hours, hourly rate (\$/hr), and narrative
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description of legal tasks performed.

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- **Automated Budget Sync:** As soon as hours are logged, the system automatically
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recalculates the matter's total spent budget.

5. Default User Accounts & Demo Credentials

The system comes pre-seeded with realistic law firm users, cases, clients, documents, and billable time entries:

Role	Staff Member	Email	Password	Permissions
Managing Partner (Admin)	Alexander Vance, Esq.	admin@justiceflow.com	password123	Full access to all matters, financial billing, staff, and firm settings.
Associate Attorney	Sarah Jenkins, Esq.	sarah.jenkins@justiceflow.com	password123	Assigned cases, document upload, and billable time entry.
Paralegal	Marcus	marcus.ross@justiceflow.com	password123	Document

Role	Staff Member	Email	Password	Permissions
Assistant	Ross			archiving, case research notes, and docket updates.

6. Security, Compliance & Data Integrity

- **SQL Injection Immunity:** All database operations utilize parameterized prepared queries through the mysql2/promise pool.
- **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC):** Authenticated requests carry digital JWT signatures verifying staff permissions.
- **Tamper-Resistant Audit Trail:** Critical operations (matter creation, time slip recording, file deletion) are logged into the audit_logs database table.

Document Formats Available:

This complete user guide is provided in **PDF format** (JUSTICEFLOW_USER_MANUAL . pdf) for printing and sharing, and in **Microsoft Word format** (JUSTICEFLOW_USER_MANUAL . docx) for firm editing and custom branding.